

The PACE Diagnostic Framework — QuotaSuccess

This is the engine under the house. The PACE Diagnostic benchmarks a company's whole go-to-market against best practice, scores each functional area on both strategy and execution, and — critically — tests whether the functions connect at the handoffs. It turns a vague sense of "growth has stalled" into a ranked, named set of gaps, a defined set of outputs, and a clear path to fix the ones that matter most.

PACE stays the method: **Position · Acquire · Convert · Expand**. Alignment is not a fifth letter — it is assessed *inside* every stage and specifically *between* stages, because most GTM value leaks at the handoffs.

The hero is the client. The CEO who wants to stop relying on heroics. The senior sales leader buried in lag reports with no time to coach. The salesperson trying to win complex deals when buyer time is harder to get than ever. QuotaSuccess finds what is stopping them and sets the pace to fix it.

Part 1 — The symptoms (how the conversation starts)

CEOs and sales leaders rarely say "our Convert motion is weak." They describe symptoms. This is the language we lead with — reframed in our own voice, covering the common signals that GTM performance is not optimal. These are the door-openers that point to a PACE gap.

Growth and predictability

- Growth has stalled and no one can say exactly why.
- Revenue can't be predicted or forecast two quarters out with any confidence.
- The number depends on a few heroes, not a repeatable play — if they leave, the pipeline leaves with them.
- You can't confidently say no to new initiatives, so focus is spread thin across too many bets.

Market and differentiation

- Your point of view isn't differentiated — buyers can't tell you apart from the next vendor.
- Discounting and feature wars are eroding the value you can charge for.
- You want to move up-market but the customer base is still SMB.
- You're consistently the last to enter a deal cycle, reacting to RFPs instead of shaping them.

The engine and the handoffs

- Sales, marketing and customer success are out of sync — each optimises its own number, value leaks between them.
- Leads get generated but don't convert, and no one owns the gap between the two.
- The CRM is full but the forecast is fiction.
- Reps are busy; the number still misses.
- You've hired salespeople but there's no system for them to run.

Leadership and time

- Your sales leaders have no time to coach — their heads are stuck in lag reports and deal escalations.
- The team is reactive, not proactive: firefighting this quarter, never building next quarter.
- It's harder than ever to get enough buyer time to run a complex sales process, so deals stall in the middle.

The back half of the journey

- Churn is quietly killing the business.
- Customers love the product but can't quantify the ROI enough to renew.
- Customers would happily buy more, but there's nothing else of value to offer them.

How we use this. The symptom list is the front of the diagnostic and the top of the website. A prospect ticks the ones that sound like them; each maps to one or more PACE domains and to the handoffs between them. The diagnostic then proves *where* the constraint actually sits — which is often not where the symptom shows up.

Part 2 — How the diagnostic works

Every functional area is assessed on four axes, so we separate a strategy problem from an execution problem from a plumbing problem:

1. **Strategy** — is it defined, deliberate and written down, or implicit and in someone's head?
2. **Execution** — is it actually run in the day-to-day, consistently, by the team?
3. **Connection (handoff)** — does it join cleanly to the stage before and after it, or does value leak at the seam?
4. **Instrumentation** — can it be measured? Are the lead and lag measures set up and visible in the CRM?

Each area is scored to a simple maturity level and rolled into a **PACE scorecard** with a heatmap. The lowest-scoring, highest-impact area becomes "the block" — the constraint we fix first.

Scoring scale (per area): Absent → Ad hoc → Defined → Repeatable → Optimised.

Part 3 — The PACE map (themes → sub-items → deliverables)

Each domain lists the functional areas we assess (the sub-items from your brain-dump, organised), and the **defined outputs** the diagnostic can produce for that domain. Deliverables are what the client walks away owning.

P — Position

Are you aimed at the right buyers, in the right market, with a position they actually feel?

What we assess

- Product-market fit evidence and repeatable existing-success motions (lookalike analysis of best current customers)
- Clear ICP, personas, and the market opportunity / TAM view
- Segmentation, target account definition and territory design
- Trigger events that signal a buyer is in-market
- Competitor and market analysis, SWOT, and differentiated point of view
- Packaging, offer design and pricing power (defence against discounting/feature wars)
- Brand analysis and the "view of the customer"
- Investment vs capability vs product readiness to support the strategy

Defined deliverables

- A single defined primary GTM strategy on a page
- Clear ICP definition + 2-4 validated personas
- Target account list logic + territory design
- Trigger-event map (what to watch, what it means)
- Competitor SWOT + differentiated positioning statement
- Packaging and pricing recommendation

Handoff test (Position → Acquire): does marketing/demand actually target the defined ICP, or is it fishing everywhere?

A — Acquire

Are you generating enough of the right pipeline, from sources you control?

What we assess

- Inbound strategy: website, SEO/AEO, content, community, "where do buyers learn and network"
- Outbound strategy: channel mix, sequencing, targeting off the ICP and trigger events
- Social selling and referral selling motions

- Lead scoring model and lead qualification into the funnel
- Marketing–sales service level between MQL and accepted pipeline
- Demand mix and reliance on heroics vs repeatable plays

Defined deliverables

- Defined inbound and outbound strategies tied to the ICP
- Channel mix and priority recommendation
- Lead scoring model (definition + build path)
- Referral and social-selling play
- "Where buyers learn and network" map to aim content and presence

Handoff test (Acquire → Convert): do generated leads convert, and does anyone own the gap when they don't?

C — Convert

How reliably and quickly do real opportunities become revenue?

What we assess

- Sales process design, stage gates and exit criteria
- Qualification framework and a usable qualification scorecard
- Lead and lag measurement — are the controllable inputs defined, tracked and coached?
- Forecasting discipline and pipeline hygiene
- Win/loss analysis and the feedback loop back to Position
- Sales skills, enablement program and onboarding
- Sales coaching playbooks and skill-development playbooks
- Manager-as-coach capacity: do leaders have time to coach, or are they stuck in lag reports?
- Compensation and growth modelling that reinforces the right behaviour
- Tools and the ability to run a complex motion inside shrinking buyer time

Defined deliverables

- Documented sales process with stage gates and exit criteria
- Qualification scorecard the team actually uses
- Lead/lag measurement model + CRM reporting design
- Win/loss review and findings
- Enablement and coaching playbooks
- Compensation / growth model review
- Manager coaching cadence

Handoff test (Convert → Expand): are expectations set in the sale honoured at delivery, or does CS inherit a reset?

E — Expand

Does revenue compound after the first sale?

What we assess

- Onboarding and customer-experience mapping across the lifecycle
- QBR rhythm and value/ROI demonstration at renewal
- Retention strategy and churn drivers
- Upsell, cross-sell and attach motions
- Referral generation from happy customers
- Net revenue retention as the compounding metric

Defined deliverables

- Customer journey / experience map
- QBR framework tied to ROI evidence
- Retention and churn-risk plan
- Upsell / attach play
- Referral motion

Handoff test (Expand → Position): do expansion and win/loss insights feed back into ICP and packaging, or is the loop open?

Part 4 — GTM Engineering (the instrumentation layer)

This runs across all four domains rather than sitting in one. It's how the strategy becomes measurable and the diagnostic stays live.

What we assess / build

- Lead and lag measurement set-up and reporting inside the CRM (RevOps)
- Monitoring: competitors, market trends and trigger events
- The lead-scoring model, built and wired in
- Dashboards and the operating cadence that surfaces the controllables to leaders — so heads come out of lag reports

Why it matters here. This is your direct sales-ops / RevOps credibility. It's what turns "we defined the strategy" into "the team can see and manage the inputs every week."

Part 5 — From diagnostic to ongoing MRR

The diagnostic is the land. The choke points it exposes decide the expand. We attach an ongoing service to whichever handoff or domain scored lowest and matters most — so the recommendation is evidence-led, not a pitch.

Where the block is	The likely ongoing service	Revenue shape
Strategy undefined across the board	QuotaSuccess Fractional — senior leadership runs the operating rhythm until it's repeatable	Retainer (MRR)
Convert: process, lead/lag, CRM reporting weak	QuotaSuccess Engineering — RevOps build, CRM lead/lag set-up, forecasting	Project → optional retainer
Convert: skills, coaching, enablement weak	QuotaSuccess Training — process design + enablement + sales-leadership development	Project → cohort/retainer
Any domain defined but not sticking at rep level	QuotaSprint — cascades the defined top-line strategy down to weekly rep-level execution	Subscription (MRR)
Client wants to run PACE themselves / at scale	QuotaSuccess Frameworks — PACE certification + toolkit licence	Licence (recurring)

QuotaSprint's role. Everything the diagnostic clarifies and defines as top-line strategy should cascade down and be reinforced at rep level. QuotaSprint is the weekly operating layer that holds that cascade in place after the engagement ends — the always-on reinforcement beneath the advisory work.

Part 6 — Design principles for this framework

- **The client is the hero.** We diagnose and equip; they win. Language centres the CEO, the sales leader and the rep — never our cleverness.
- **Name the block, don't boil the ocean.** The output is a ranked constraint, not a 40-item to-do list.
- **Evidence before advice.** Scores and handoff tests justify every recommendation.
- **Deliverables clients own.** A defined GTM strategy, ICP, personas, process — assets they keep whether or not they retain us.
- **Controllables over lag.** Everything ties back to managing the lead measures that produce the lags — the philosophy the whole house runs on.
- **Respect shrinking buyer time.** The motions we design assume it's harder than ever to get in front of buyers, so process and enablement earn every minute.